

Samia Menon

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Education & Honors

University of California, Berkeley

PH.D. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE (ADVISED BY BJÖRN HARTMANN AND MARTI HEARST)

Berkeley, CA

Aug. 2025 - Present

- National Science Foundation CSGrad4US Fellow)
- Chancellor's Fellow
- EECS Excellence Award

Columbia University (School of Engineering and Applied Science)

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE WITH A MINOR IN ANTHROPOLOGY

New York, NY

Aug. 2019 - May 2023

- Magna Cum Laude (GPA: 3.996/4.00)
- C.P. Davis Scholar

Publications & Presentations

Under Submission

Sitong Wang, **Samia Menon**, Dingzeyu Li, Xiaojuan Ma, Richard Zemel, Lydia B. Chilton. 2025. Schemex: Interactive Structural Abstraction from Examples with Contrastive Refinement. *Under submission*.

Conference and Journal Papers

Samia Menon, Sitong Wang, and Lydia B. Chilton. 2024. MoodSmith: Enabling Mood-Consistent Multimedia for AI-Generated Advocacy Campaigns. In *Proceedings of the the 15th Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC '24)*, (Jönköping, Sweden), Association for Computational Creativity.

Sinan L. Aktay, Ozan A. Aktay, **Samia Menon**, Shuo Jim Huang, Rozalina G. McCoy (In press). 2025. Supporting public transit research in healthcare settings: Testing a free, fast, and secure method for routing public transit from patient address to the point of care. In *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association*.

Sitong Wang, **Samia Menon**, Tao Long, Keren Henderson, Dingzeyu Li, Kevin Crowston, Mark Hansen, Jeffrey V Nickerson, and Lydia B Chilton. 2024. ReelFramer: Human-AI Co-Creation for News-to-Video Translation. In *Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24)*, (Honolulu, Hawai'i, USA), Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 169, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642868>

Tao Long, Dorothy Zhang, Grace Li, Batool Taraif, **Samia Menon**, Kynneddy Smith, Sitong Wang, Katy Gero, Lydia B. Chilton. 2023. Tweetorial Hooks: Generative AI Tools to Motivate Science on Social Media. In *Proceedings of the the 14th Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC '23)*, (Waterloo, ON, Canada), Association for Computational Creativity.

Talks

Samia Menon Designing for Dialogue: Computational Tools for Conservation Communication. 2025. Presented at SCCS-NY, New York, NY, USA, October 2025. (*Best Speed Talk Award: Best Use of Emerging Technologies*)

Samia Menon and Sahil Patel. Visualizing Virality. 2023. Presented at *Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society Symposium*, New York, NY, USA, April 2023.

Research Experience

Berkeley Institute of Design Lab (Supervised by Björn Hartmann and Marti Hearst)

Berkeley, CA

RESEARCHER

Aug. 2025 - present

- Researches Human-AI interaction, specifically how algorithmically-mediated environments (social media platforms, agent interactions) re-shapes information proliferation, human behavior, and community formation.
- Applies methods in machine learning and computational social science to build systems that enhance human understanding, expression, and connection within these new paradigms.

Computational Design Lab (Supervised by Prof. Lydia Chilton)

RESEARCHER

- Designed, implemented, and conducted studies on system (MoodSmith) leveraging generative AI to allow non-profit organizations to effectively explore a spectrum of narrative ‘moods’ in their advocacy campaigns.
- Created human-AI collaborative workflows for scriptwriting and storyboarding for news-to-video translation system (ReelFramer).
- Conducted user studies to investigate efficacy of AI-supported Tweakorial Hook writing system.

New York, NY

Sep. 2022 - Apr. 2025

Brown Institute for Media Innovation

DATA VISUALIZATION

- Designed and implemented a data visualization investigating how virality is defined and achieved on the Twitter (now X) platform.
- Developed final app in React and p5.js.
- Presented work at the Knight First Amendment Institute’s *Algorithmic Amplification and Society* symposium.

New York, NY

Jan. 2023 - May 2023

Work Experience

Squarespace

SOFTWARE ENGINEER (IC 3)

- Planned, organized, and lead work for major projects including coordination of multiple engineers, encompassing pioneer AI integrations and major functionality updates.
- Led work to implement 2024 Black Friday Campaign, including restructuring queuing infrastructure to create a more resilient email sending pipeline (25x faster) and developing the frontend ‘playbook’ experience, allowing for a record 15 million messages / day sent.
- Tackled issues in email deliverability, domains, phishing, and traffic routing.

New York, NY

Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2025

American Museum of Natural History (AMNH) & Brown Institute for Media Innovation

EXPERIENCE LEAD & TECHNOLOGIST (VOLUNTEER)

- Scoped, designed, and executed an AR experience, *Carbon Catchers*, in the Hall of Ocean life at the AMNH as a member of the leadership team behind the project.
- Designed and implemented key aspects of *Carbon Catchers*, including multiple games, user interface features, the final React application, and general visitor experience.
- Facilitated exhibit during *EarthFest 2024* (Earth Day at the Museum) to museum visitors.

New York, NY

Jan. 2024 - May 2024

Service Experience

NYC Audubon

VOLUNTEER

- Monitored and counted horseshoe crabs along Plumb Beach in Brooklyn, New York.

New York, NY

May. 2023 - May. 2024

Columbia Girls Who Code

VP FINANCE

- Secured and distributed funding to support in-person computer science classes for high-school girls in the NYC area.
- Provided free MetroCards for all students for whom transportation cost was an obstacle to attendance.

New York, NY

Nov. 2019 - May 2023

Meet Me at the Museum

TOUR GUIDE

- Supported free, in-person museum tours of the Metropolitan Museum of Art for NYC public elementary schools.
- Delivered free virtual art museum tours to elementary and middle school classes during the COVID-19 pandemic.

New York, NY

Oct. 2019 - May 2023

Teaching Experience

Introduction to Databases (Columbia Computer Science)

COURSE ASSISTANT

- Mentored several teams through creating a database schema, implementing their database in PostgreSQL, and creating a functional app.
- Supported instructor by holding office hours, responding to student questions online and attending virtual lecture, and grading assignments + exams.

New York, NY

Aug. 2022 - Dec. 2022

Clean Object-Oriented Design (Columbia Computer Science)

COURSE ASSISTANT

- Held OH, created answer keys and rubrics for homework assignments, answered online questions, and graded homework assignments.

New York, NY

Aug. 2021 - Dec. 2021

Skills

DevOps	Docker, Kubernetes, Jira, Gradle, Grafana, Google Cloud Logging
Backend	Spring, REST API, Redis Caching, MongoDB, Mockito Testing, Queue Infrastructure, DKIM/SPF Validation
Frontend	React, HTML5, CSS, Figma, A-Frame, d3.js, p5.js
Programming	Java, Python, Java/Typescript, SQL, C++, MATLAB, LaTeX
Languages	English (Native), French (Advanced)
Other	Public Speaking, UI Design, Video Editing, Illustration